

Zenbook prime

ASUS announced their new Zenbook primes sporting 1080p IPS panels and ivy-bridge
<http://dgit.in/IDINDj>



A glowing read

Nook announced that its "Nook Simple Touch with GlowLight" has started to ship out
<http://dgit.in/J9fxRV>

out on the Aura maps. What we can't understand is why price these two devices within ₹500 of each other, when clearly the Zx250 makes more sense! Not that there is anything wrong with the Vx240. Similarly, if you are considering the RoadPilot II Premium, we suggest spending a bit more and getting the x140s Premium, which is quicker and feels a lot more upmarket.

TomTom Via

We just love these two TomTom devices, and while these maps aren't 3D, they still look gorgeous and very much usable. They are the most matter of fact navigators in this entire bunch. It's also a no-nonsense device with almost a German precision. Switch on the Via 120 and the Via 125, and it opens up straight on the Maps application. Extremely quick GPS lock times help in that motive as well. Navigation quality is at par with what Garmin offers. The amaz-

ingly clean UI is easy to navigate even for a newbie.

SatGuide

Both SatGuide devices were very different from each other as far as the navigation software UI was concerned. The 4.3 Navi doesn't take you straight to the map when you open the navigation software. Disappointingly, the navigation quality offered by these maps was confusing for the most part. Once off the main roads, it did give some confusing directions. Clearly, the road which we use daily for the last two years or so has not been mapped. But, gains back some lost ground by offering very good quality voice guidance quality. A whole bunch of value-adds as well.

Primo GPS

Both devices – PG400X and the PG500X use the software and maps that look and perform very similar to the ones on the SatGuide navigators. The navigation quality is similar as well.

There are similar issues with navigation quality and precision as well. SatGuide and Primo GPS devices have up to the mark navigation quality and clarity, which is pretty much customizable as well, in terms of voice and language options. A whole host of other features – FM Radio, Picture and video viewer and MP3 player integrated, as well as an ebook reader and built-in games.

WINNERS

Best Performer

The Garmin Nuvi 2565LM is the winner of the Best Performance award. It has quick startup and standby-on times, but only average GPS lock times. Where it gets the advantage is because of the excellent display quality, touchscreen response, voice guidance and quality of navigation overall. MapmyIndia Zx250 and TomTom Via 125 ran it close though.



Garmin nuvi 2565LM (India)

Best value (Low and mid-range category)

The MapmyIndiaRoadPilot is the second most inexpensive device in this test (@ ₹7,990), and yet scores better than the more expensive rivals – Satguide 5.0 Navi, both Primo GPS devices and even its cousin the RoadPilot II Premium. If you are in the market for a budget navigator, this is the one to buy.

Best Value (High-end category)

MapmyIndia's Zx250 - their most premium navigator in this test is considerably less expensive than the Garmin Nuvi 2565LM, but runs it very close in terms of performance. If you believe that the Garmin one at ₹18,990 is a little expensive, the Zx250 at ₹15,990 offers very similar good performance and detailed feature set, and the unique Aura maps experience.

Editor's Pick

We believe that the TomTomVia 120 is the device that you should pick if none of the riff-raff of features matter to and you just want to get down to the navigation bit as soon as the device starts. And oh boy does the Via 120 start quickly. This is the most matter of fact navigator you can buy. Costs less than the Via 125, and the only real difference between the Via 120 and the Via 125 is the different display size - 4.3-inches to 5.0-inches. **d**

HOW WE TESTED

UNIFORM ROUTES

We charted out two test routes in Delhi NCR, which covered a heady mix of colony roads, main roads and National Highways, and some popular POIs like restaurants. The idea was to see how the maps guide us on main roads, and how precise they are on colony roads, which is usually a confusing spaghetti of tarmac.

MAPS & NAVIGATION

Navigation devices of different brands have their own unique package. Their mapping is done in a different way, and the maps themselves are very different. Navigation quality and even the ability to re-route a journey was compared.

CAR, DRIVER, DRIVING STYLE

To keep everything constant, we

used the same car, with the same driver. Some of these devices have the Eco feature - calculate fuel average etc., and a standard driving style helps compare the accuracy if need be. For example, the Garmin Nuvi navigator has the Trends feature, as well as the ability to understand the users' navigation behavior. We avoided the slightest difference in engine displacement to keep all elements constant for precise results.

PARAMETERS

Apart from startup time, we tested and rated the devices on the following parameters.

Navigation quality

We rated quality of navigation offered by each device, based on the precision on both test routes.

Voice navigation

We rate all devices on the quality of voice navigation, the amount of options available for language and voice clarity.

Display & Sound quality

Two critical features on a navigation device. If you cannot see the map clearly and quickly while driving, or the audio isn't clear enough, then what is the point? We rate these features based on how well they performed.

GPS lock time

This is the final piece of the jigsaw. Once the GPS is locked on, after a complete boot, you can input your destination and be on the way. The quicker devices score more points. The results are tabulated in the chart on the previous pages.